# SSC CHSL 2021 Tier-I question paper with answers

**7 June 2022 · Shift 2**

74 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 26 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20220816140307/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerKeys_%20CHSLE2021_16082022.pdf

## English Language 21 questions

**Q.1**

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Chip off the old block

**(A)** Someone who resembles their parent
**(B)** Someone who makes the right decision
**(C)** Someone who tries to escape from their parents
**(D)** Someone who spoils other's enjoyment

**Q.4**

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. He ran “most happily” to receive his father.

**(A)** happily
**(B)** happier
**(C)** happy
**(D)** more happily

**Q.5**

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The rumours usually _____ like wild fire.

**(A)** spreading
**(B)** spread
**(C)** spreads
**(D)** are spreading

**Q.6**

Fill in the blank with the correctly spelt word. There was a feeling of _____ in his eyes.

**(A)** vengaence
**(B)** vengense
**(C)** vengence
**(D)** vengeance

**Q.7**

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. He always ____ a tantrum about something or the other.

**(A)** through
**(B)** threw
**(C)** tough
**(D)** true

**Q.8**

Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph. A. Intelligent and strikingly attractive, Tess is indisputably the central character of the novel that bears her name. B. But she is also more than a distinctive individual: Hardy makes her into somewhat of a mythic heroine. C. Her name, formally Theresa, recalls St. Teresa of Avila, another martyr whose vision of a higher reality cost her, her life. D. Tess’s story, thus, is a story representing a deeper and larger experience than that of a single individual.

**(A)** ACDB
**(B)** BACD
**(C)** DCBA
**(D)** ABCD

**Q.9**

Select the most appropriate synonym of the word given in the brackets to fill in the blank. In 1024, a king named Mahmood _____ (robbed) a city called Anhilwad.

**(A)** conquered
**(B)** plundered
**(C)** annexed
**(D)** attacked

**Q.10**

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. The mob / is believing / every word / the leader says.

**(A)** is believing
**(B)** the leader says
**(C)** every word
**(D)** The mob

**Q.12**

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice. Parker has been bitten by a rare species of spiders.

**(A)** A rare species of spiders had bitten Parker.
**(B)** A rare species of spiders is biting Parker.
**(C)** A rare species of spiders has bitten Parker.
**(D)** A rare species of spiders bit Parker.

**Q.13**

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error Investing on real estate / can earn you quick profit / but it comes with / a certain amount of risk attached to it.

**(A)** a certain amount of risk attached to it
**(B)** can earn you quick profit
**(C)** Investing on real estate
**(D)** but it comes with

**Q.14**

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. The minor project put forward by the government “is now moving around into” its third year.

**(A)** is now moving into
**(B)** is now moving along into
**(C)** is now moving at
**(D)** are now moving into

**Q.15**

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

**(A)** Management
**(B)** Enthusiasm
**(C)** Bibblography
**(D)** Intelligence

**Q.17**

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select ‘No substitution required’. Rahul “shall write” the exam at this time next week.

**(A)** No substitution required
**(B)** will have been written
**(C)** would be writing
**(D)** shall be writing

**Q.18**

Select the sentence which has no spelling error.

**(A)** Mala asked students to aggreggate examples of many chemicals.
**(B)** Final results will be declared on the basis of agregate marks.
**(C)** Chromosomes are aggregatte and closely linked in a cell.
**(D)** My son’s aggregate marks were very poor in the previous year.

**Q.19**

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Resolute

**(A)** Bulky
**(B)** Agreeable
**(C)** Victorious
**(D)** Strong

**Q.20**

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. An omission of duty

**(A)** Surrende
**(B)** Delinquency
**(C)** Deliberation
**(D)** Delineation

**Q.21**

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The next Faerie Market was held (1)_____ schedule (2)_____ the other side of the wall. The two boys were not allowed to go to the market, but they wanted to. This was a source of great (3)_____ to the boys. The younger of the two had a kitten. She grew slowly but was the sweetest cat in the world, until, one evening, she began to (4)_____ around the house impatiently. The cat was off in the dark and the boy never saw the cat again. He was (5)_____ for a while.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

**(A)** on
**(B)** by
**(C)** at
**(D)** upon

**Q.22**

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The next Faerie Market was held (1)_____ schedule (2)_____ the other side of the wall. The two boys were not allowed to go to the market, but they wanted to. This was a source of great (3)_____ to the boys. The younger of the two had a kitten. She grew slowly but was the sweetest cat in the world, until, one evening, she began to (4)_____ around the house impatiently. The cat was off in the dark and the boy never saw the cat again. He was (5)_____ for a while.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

**(A)** at
**(B)** on
**(C)** upon
**(D)** in

**Q.23**

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The next Faerie Market was held (1)_____ schedule (2)_____ the other side of the wall. The two boys were not allowed to go to the market, but they wanted to. This was a source of great (3)_____ to the boys. The younger of the two had a kitten. She grew slowly but was the sweetest cat in the world, until, one evening, she began to (4)_____ around the house impatiently. The cat was off in the dark and the boy never saw the cat again. He was (5)_____ for a while.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

**(A)** abhorrence
**(B)** irritation
**(C)** ebullience
**(D)** hatred

**Q.24**

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The next Faerie Market was held (1)_____ schedule (2)_____ the other side of the wall. The two boys were not allowed to go to the market, but they wanted to. This was a source of great (3)_____ to the boys. The younger of the two had a kitten. She grew slowly but was the sweetest cat in the world, until, one evening, she began to (4)_____ around the house impatiently. The cat was off in the dark and the boy never saw the cat again. He was (5)_____ for a while.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

**(A)** sleep
**(B)** march
**(C)** prowl
**(D)** trot

**Q.25**

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The next Faerie Market was held (1)_____ schedule (2)_____ the other side of the wall. The two boys were not allowed to go to the market, but they wanted to. This was a source of great (3)_____ to the boys. The younger of the two had a kitten. She grew slowly but was the sweetest cat in the world, until, one evening, she began to (4)_____ around the house impatiently. The cat was off in the dark and the boy never saw the cat again. He was (5)_____ for a while.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

**(A)** petrified
**(B)** inconsolable
**(C)** sanguine
**(D)** blithesome

## General Intelligence 16 questions

**Q.2**

Study the given pattern carefully and select the number that can replace the question mark (?) in it. First row: 24, 12, 27 Second row: 29, 13, 64 Third row: 32, 24, ? (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the number into its constituent digits. For example, 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding/deleting/multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

**(A)** 9
**(B)** 15
**(C)** 8
**(D)** 18

**Q.3**

In a certain code language, 'LETTUCE' is written as 'ECUTTEL' and ‘PEPPERS’ is written as ‘SREPPEP’. How will 'PARSNIP' be written in that language?

**(A)** PINSARP
**(B)** PNISRAP
**(C)** PINSRAP
**(D)** PISNRAP

**Q.6**

Seven friends S, T, U, V, W, X and Y, each has a different age. W is older than X but younger than V. Only three people are older than V. T is older than U but younger than S. Y is the youngest among all. How many persons are younger than U?

**(A)** 4
**(B)** 2
**(C)** 1
**(D)** 5

**Q.7**

Select the option that is related to the fifth term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and the fourth term is related to the third term. EVIDENT : NTIDEEV :: DYNAMIC : ICNAMDY :: FICTION : ?

**(A)** NOICTIF
**(B)** ONTCIFI
**(C)** NOITCIF
**(D)** ONCTIFI

**Q.8**

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? 1024, 1032, 1059, 1123, ?

**(A)** 1248
**(B)** 1252
**(C)** 1254
**(D)** 1250

**Q.9**

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to sequentially replace the * signs and to balance the given equation. 25 * 5 * 10 * 2 * 8 * 17

**(A)** ÷, +, ×, −, =
**(B)** −, +, ÷, ×, =
**(C)** ×, ÷, −, +, =
**(D)** ÷, ×, −, +, =

**Q.11**

Which letter-cluster will replace the question mark (?) to complete the given series? OLJB, ?, IVDL, FAAQ, CFXV

**(A)** LQGG
**(B)** ROFJ
**(C)** SRGK
**(D)** LRFK

**Q.14**

The second number in the given number pairs is obtained by performing certain mathematical operation(s) on the first number. The same operation(s) are followed in all the number pairs except one. Find that odd number pair.

**(A)** 169 : 11
**(B)** 25 : 5
**(C)** 36 : 4
**(D)** 9 : 1

**Q.15**

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? 16, 32, 29, ?, 111, 666

**(A)** 132
**(B)** 128
**(C)** 120
**(D)** 116

**Q.17**

Select the option that is related to the fifth number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the fourth number is related to the third number. 6 : 24 :: 9 : 54 :: 12 : ?

**(A)** 88
**(B)** 98
**(C)** 96
**(D)** 86

**Q.19**

If P denotes '×', Q denotes '÷', R denotes '+' and S denotes '−', then what will come in place of '?' in the following equation? (128 Q 8) R (5 P 7) S 23 R (18 P 2) = ?

**(A)** 60
**(B)** 64
**(C)** 74
**(D)** 70

**Q.20**

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to replace the * signs and to balance the given equation.
48 * 12 * 625 * 25 * 21

**(A)** =, ×, −,+
**(B)** =, ×, ×, ×
**(C)** ÷, +, =, +
**(D)** ÷, =, ÷, −

**Q.21**

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? 5, 9, 21, 43, 91, 185, ?

**(A)** 366
**(B)** 367
**(C)** 377
**(D)** 376

**Q.23**

Which letter-cluster will replace the question mark (?) to complete the given series? TSXA, XBLT, ?, FTNF, JCBY

**(A)** LUWQ
**(B)** CJSM
**(C)** FKEW
**(D)** BKZM

**Q.24**

The second number in the given number-pairs is obtained by performing certain mathematical operation(s) on the first number. The same operation(s) are followed in all the number-pairs EXCEPT one. Find that odd number-pair.

**(A)** 1 : 2
**(B)** 3 : 5
**(C)** 7 : 25
**(D)** 5 : 13

**Q.25**

In a certain code language, 'BRIGHT' is written as 'IYTRGS' and 'LOCATE' is written as 'LOZXVG'. How will 'COSTLY' be written in that language?

**(A)** XLGHBO
**(B)** LXHGOB
**(C)** XLHGBO
**(D)** LXGHBO

## Quantitative Aptitude 14 questions

**Q.1**

The average of five numbers, given in a particular order, is 32. The average of the first three numbers is 28, while that of the last three numbers is 34. What is the average of the first two numbers?

**(A)** 29
**(B)** 30
**(C)** 27
**(D)** 28

**Q.3**

Simplify $11.5 - [5 + 0.5 \times (9 - 3 \times 2)]$

**(A)** 5
**(B)** 4
**(C)** 3
**(D)** 6

**Q.4**

Find the principal amount if the interest compounded annually at the rate of 10% for two years is ₹4,200.

**(A)** ₹17,500
**(B)** ₹20,000
**(C)** ₹24,000
**(D)** ₹16,000

**Q.5**

Which of the following numbers is NOT divisible by 75?

**(A)** 117975
**(B)** 275475
**(C)** 163750
**(D)** 666600

**Q.10**

The area of two similar triangles XYZ and ABC are 361 $cm^2$ and 225 $cm^2$, respectively. If the longest side of the larger Δ XYZ be 38 cm, then what is the length (in cm) of the longest side of the smaller Δ ABC?

**(A)** 35
**(B)** 28
**(C)** 32
**(D)** 30

**Q.11**

"The difference between the CI and the SI on a sum of money lent for 2 years at 20% interest per annum is ₹ 80. The sum is:"

**(A)** ₹1,200
**(B)** ₹2,000
**(C)** ₹1,500
**(D)** ₹1,000

**Q.12**

The price of a book is first increased by 8% and later decreased by 8%. What is the percentage change in the price of the book?

**(A)** No change
**(B)** decrease by 0.64%
**(C)** increase by 0.064%
**(D)** increase by 0.64%

**Q.13**

A book with a marked price of ₹600 is available at a discount of 18%. What is the discount given?

**(A)** ₹180
**(B)** ₹110
**(C)** ₹108
**(D)** ₹72

**Q.14**

The price of a pen is first increased by 15% and later on the price was decreased by 20% due to reduction in sales. Find the net percentage change in the final price of a pen.

**(A)** 25%
**(B)** 8%
**(C)** –8%
**(D)** –16%

**Q.15**

Simplify the following expression. (0.14×0.14)-(2×0.14×5.14)+(5.14×5.14)

**(A)** 5.18
**(B)** 4
**(C)** 16
**(D)** 25

**Q.16**

An athlete crosses a distance of 3600 m in 12 minutes. What is his speed (in km/h)?

**(A)** 15
**(B)** 17
**(C)** 18
**(D)** 16

**Q.18**

Which of the following ratios is the smallest? 3 : 4, 1 : 2 , 2 : 5, 1 : 3

**(A)** 1:3
**(B)** 2:5
**(C)** 3:4
**(D)** 1:2

**Q.21**

A shopkeeper sells rice at cost price but uses a faulty weighing machine and thus gains a profit of 25%. Find how many grams rice he is giving in 1 kg ?

**(A)** 800gm
**(B)** 700gm
**(C)** 900gm
**(D)** 750 gm

**Q.24**

The average salary per head of all the workers in a workshop is ₹8,850. If the average salary per head of 9 technicians is ₹10,000, and the average salary per head of the rest is ₹7,780, find the total number of workers in the workshop.(Consider integral part only)

**(A)** 18
**(B)** 22
**(C)** 24
**(D)** 16

## General Awareness 23 questions

**Q.1**

In the early 1900s, which German climatologist divided the world's climate into different categories based on temperature, amount of rainfall and the time of year when rainfall occurs?

**(A)** Michael Wille
**(B)** Wladimir Koppen
**(C)** Rudolf Geiger
**(D)** Alfred Wegener

**Q.2**

Ustad Allah Rakha was famous for playing the _____.

**(A)** tabla
**(B)** sitar
**(C)** sarod
**(D)** bansuri

**Q.3**

Who among the following, after winning the Russian Grand Prix 2021, became the first F1 driver to win 100 races?

**(A)** George Russell
**(B)** Valtteri Bottas
**(C)** Carlos Sainz
**(D)** Lewis Hamilton

**Q.4**

Pt Bhimsen Joshi is associated with which of the following?

**(A)** Hindustani music vocalist
**(B)** Sarod
**(C)** Sitar
**(D)** Carnatic music vocalist

**Q.5**

Which is the toxin-causing bacterium that spoils cream, cheese and milk and makes them taste bitter, sour or bitter?

**(A)** Bacillus cereus
**(B)** Streptococcus thermophilus
**(C)** Bifidobacterium
**(D)** Lactobacillus plantarum

**Q.6**

Which north bank tributary of the Ganges River comprises of two streams, namely Kaligandak and Trishulganga?

**(A)** Mahananda River
**(B)** Gandak River
**(C)** Kosi River
**(D)** Ghagra River

**Q.7**

Guru MK Saroja has been conferred with the Padma Shri for the relentless pursuit of which of the following dances?

**(A)** Bharatanatyam
**(B)** Mohiniyattam
**(C)** Odissi
**(D)** Kuchipudi

**Q.8**

'The Autobiography of an Unknown Indian' is the autobiography of _____.

**(A)** UV Swaminathan Iyer
**(B)** Anna Chandy
**(C)** Nirad C. Chaudhuri
**(D)** Inder Kumar Gujral

**Q.9**

V Satyanarayana Sarma, an exponent of the Kuchipudi dance form was conferred which of the following awards by the Government of India?

**(A)** Padma Shri
**(B)** Kala Shastri Award
**(C)** Padma Bhushan
**(D)** Padma Vibhushan

**Q.10**

What is a biotechnological process accomplished by yeast, some type of bacteria, or some other microorganism to convert sugar into ethyl alcohol and carbon dioxide?

**(A)** Pasteurisation
**(B)** Lactic acid fermentation
**(C)** Alcoholic fermentation
**(D)** Glycolysis

**Q.12**

The 'Kalidas Samman' is awarded by the government of which of the following Indian states?

**(A)** Madhya Pradesh
**(B)** Tamil Nadu
**(C)** Uttar Pradesh
**(D)** Gujarat

**Q.13**

Antonie van Leeuwenhoek was known for which discovery in late 17th century?

**(A)** Discovery of the properties of a stem cell
**(B)** Observation of bacteria and protozoa
**(C)** Discovery of the role of ATP as the source of energy for cells
**(D)** Discovery of nucleus in the cell

**Q.15**

Who among the following Indian music composers and singers, who is popular by nickname 'the Mozart of Madras', was placed in The Time's list of the world's most influential people in 2009?

**(A)** MS Viswanathan
**(B)** AR Rahman
**(C)** Shankar Mahadevan
**(D)** RD Burman

**Q.16**

The 'Room on the roof' a novel about an orphaned English boy living with his guardian is written by whom among the following authors?

**(A)** Khushwant Singh
**(B)** Arundhati Roy
**(C)** Manohar Malgaonkar
**(D)** Ruskin Bond

**Q.17**

Which of the following Indian cities will host the International Olympic Committee session in 2023?

**(A)** Delhi
**(B)** Bengaluru
**(C)** Mumbai
**(D)** Hyderabad

**Q.18**

The historical fiction novel 'The King Within' is authored by:

**(A)** Krishna Sobti
**(B)** Indu Sundaresan
**(C)** Nandini Sengupta
**(D)** Kiran Nagarkar

**Q.19**

Who among the following was appointed as the head coach of the Indian cricket team in November 2021?

**(A)** Saurav Ganguly
**(B)** Sachin Tendulkar
**(C)** Rahul Dravid
**(D)** Ravi Shastri

**Q.20**

Identify the word that means vertical columns of Periodic Table.

**(A)** Valence electrons
**(B)** Groups
**(C)** Periods
**(D)** Orbitals

**Q.21**

Vedantam Satyanarayana Sarma was an exponent of which Indian classical dance form?

**(A)** Odissi
**(B)** Bharatanatyam
**(C)** Kuchipudi
**(D)** Kathak

**Q.22**

Where is the JRD Tata Sports Complex located?

**(A)** Visakhapatnam
**(B)** Ranchi
**(C)** Rourkela
**(D)** Jamshedpur

**Q.23**

A judge of the High Court retires at the age of _____.

**(A)** 60
**(B)** 56
**(C)** 65
**(D)** 62

**Q.24**

The Regional Rural Banks Act was passed in _____.

**(A)** 1976
**(B)** 1956
**(C)** 1986
**(D)** 1966

**Q.25**

Dr. Purushottam Dadheech, who was awarded the prestigious Padma Shri award in 2020, is associated with which of the following dance forms?

**(A)** Mohiniyattam
**(B)** Kuchipudi
**(C)** Kathak
**(D)** Odissi

# Answer key

### English Language

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Q.1 **(A)** | Q.4 **(A)** | Q.5 **(B)** | Q.6 **(D)** | Q.7 **(B)** | Q.8 **(D)** |
| Q.9 **(B)** | Q.10 **(A)** | Q.12 **(C)** | Q.13 **(C)** | Q.14 **(A)** | Q.15 **(C)** |
| Q.17 **(D)** | Q.18 **(D)** | Q.19 **(D)** | Q.20 **(B)** | Q.21 **(A)** | Q.22 **(B)** |
| Q.23 **(B)** | Q.24 **(C)** | Q.25 **(B)** | | | |

### General Intelligence

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Q.2 **(C)** | Q.3 **(C)** | Q.6 **(A)** | Q.7 **(D)** | Q.8 **(A)** | Q.9 **(A)** |
| Q.11 **(A)** | Q.14 **(B)** | Q.15 **(D)** | Q.17 **(C)** | Q.19 **(B)** | Q.20 **(D)** |
| Q.21 **(C)** | Q.23 **(D)** | Q.24 **(A)** | Q.25 **(D)** | | |

### Quantitative Aptitude

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Q.1 **(A)** | Q.3 **(A)** | Q.4 **(B)** | Q.5 **(C)** | Q.10 **(D)** | Q.11 **(B)** |
| Q.12 **(B)** | Q.13 **(C)** | Q.14 **(C)** | Q.15 **(D)** | Q.16 **(C)** | Q.18 **(A)** |
| Q.21 **(A)** | Q.24 **(A)** | | | | |

### General Awareness

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Q.1 **(B)** | Q.2 **(A)** | Q.3 **(D)** | Q.4 **(A)** | Q.5 **(A)** | Q.6 **(B)** |
| Q.7 **(A)** | Q.8 **(C)** | Q.9 **(A)** | Q.10 **(C)** | Q.12 **(A)** | Q.13 **(B)** |
| Q.15 **(B)** | Q.16 **(D)** | Q.17 **(C)** | Q.18 **(C)** | Q.19 **(C)** | Q.20 **(B)** |
| Q.21 **(C)** | Q.22 **(D)** | Q.23 **(D)** | Q.24 **(A)** | Q.25 **(C)** | |

## Explanations

### English Language

**Q.1 · Answer (A) Someone who resembles their parent**

A 'chip off the old block' is someone who resembles a parent in character or behaviour.

**Q.4 · Answer (A) happily**

SSC's key gives the plain adverb: 'He ran happily to receive his father.' 'Happy' and 'happier' are adjectives and 'more happily' needs a comparison; 'most happily', meaning 'very happily', is also acceptable English, but there is no 'no substitution' option.

**Q.5 · Answer (B) spread**

A habitual action with the plural subject 'rumours' takes the simple present plural: 'The rumours usually spread like wild fire.'

**Q.6 · Answer (D) vengeance**

The correct spelling is 'vengeance'.

**Q.7 · Answer (B) threw**

To 'throw a tantrum' is to have a fit of temper; its past tense is 'threw'. 'Through' only sounds the same.

**Q.8 · Answer (D) ABCD**

A introduces Tess, B ('But she is also more ...') says Hardy makes her a mythic heroine, C supports this through her name, and D ('thus') draws the conclusion: ABCD.

**Q.9 · Answer (B) plundered**

To 'plunder' a place is to rob it by force, as an invading army does.

**Q.10 · Answer (A) is believing**

'Believe' is a stative verb and is not used in the continuous: 'The mob believes every word the leader says.'

**Q.12 · Answer (C) A rare species of spiders has bitten Parker.**

The present perfect passive 'has been bitten' becomes the present perfect active 'has bitten': 'A rare species of spiders has bitten Parker.'

**Q.13 · Answer (C) Investing on real estate**

One invests 'in' something, not 'on': 'Investing in real estate'.

**Q.14 · Answer (A) is now moving into**

A project enters its third year: 'is now moving into its third year'. 'Moving around' means going from place to place, and 'are' does not agree with 'project'.

**Q.15 · Answer (C) Bibblography**

The correct spelling is 'bibliography'.

**Q.17 · Answer (D) shall be writing**

An action that will be in progress at a set time in the future takes the future continuous: 'Rahul shall be writing the exam at this time next week.'

**Q.18 · Answer (D) My son’s aggregate marks were very poor in the previous year.**

The correct spelling is 'aggregate': 'gg' only after the first 'a', and a single 't'.

**Q.19 · Answer (D) Strong**

'Resolute' means firm and determined: 'strong' in purpose.

**Q.20 · Answer (B) Delinquency**

Delinquency is a failure to do one's duty. Deliberation is careful thought and delineation is description or outlining.

**Q.21 · Answer (A) on**
Something held at the planned time is held 'on schedule'.

**Q.22 · Answer (B) on**
The market was held 'on the other side of the wall'.

**Q.23 · Answer (B) irritation**
Being kept from a market they wanted to visit was a source of 'irritation'; 'abhorrence' and 'hatred' are far too strong, and 'ebullience' means cheerfulness.

**Q.24 · Answer (C) prowl**
A restless cat 'prowls', moving about stealthily, around the house.

**Q.25 · Answer (B) inconsolable**
Having lost his cat, the boy was 'inconsolable', too upset to be comforted.

### General Intelligence

**Q.2 · Answer (C) 8**
In each row the third number is the cube of a quarter of the difference of the first two: (24 – 12)/4 = 3 and $3^3$ = 27; (29 – 13)/4 = 4 and $4^3$ = 64. So (32 – 24)/4 = 2 and $2^3$ = 8.

**Q.3 · Answer (C) PINSRAP**
Each word is written backwards: LETTUCE → ECUTTEL and PEPPERS → SREPPEP. So PARSNIP → PINSRAP.

**Q.6 · Answer (A) 4**
Only three people are older than V, so V is fourth oldest; W and X come below V, and Y is youngest, so W, X and Y take the last three places. S, T and U (S > T > U) take the top three, so U is third oldest and four people (V, W, X, Y) are younger.

**Q.7 · Answer (D) ONCTIFI**
The last two letters move to the front, the middle three stay and the first two go to the end: EV IDE NT → NT IDE EV and DY NAM IC → IC NAM DY. So FI CTI ON → ON CTI FI: ONCTIFI.

**Q.8 · Answer (A) 1248**
The differences are cubes: +8 ($2^3$), +27 ($3^3$), +64 ($4^3$), so next +125 ($5^3$): 1123 + 125 = 1248.

**Q.9 · Answer (A) ÷, +, ×, –, =**
25 ÷ 5 + 10 × 2 – 8 = 5 + 20 – 8 = 17.

**Q.11 · Answer (A) LQGG**
First letters move back 3 (O, L, I, F, C), second letters forward 5 (L, Q, V, A, F), third letters back 3 (J, G, D, A, X) and fourth letters forward 5 (B, G, L, Q, V): LQGG.

**Q.14 · Answer (B) 25 : 5**
The second number is the square root of the first minus 2: √169 – 2 = 11, √36 – 2 = 4 and √9 – 2 = 1. √25 – 2 = 3, not 5, so 25 : 5 is the odd pair.

**Q.15 · Answer (D) 116**
The operations are ×2, –3, ×4, –5, ×6: 16 × 2 = 32, 32 – 3 = 29, 29 × 4 = 116, then 116 – 5 = 111 and 111 × 6 = 666.

**Q.17 · Answer (C) 96**
The second number is two-thirds of the square of the first: $6^2$ × 2/3 = 24 and $9^2$ × 2/3 = 54. Likewise $12^2$ × 2/3 = 96.

**Q.19 · Answer (B) 64**
After substituting the signs: (128 ÷ 8) + (5 × 7) – 23 + (18 × 2) = 16 + 35 – 23 + 36 = 64.

**Q.20 · Answer (D) ÷, =, ÷, –**
48 ÷ 12 = 625 ÷ 25 – 21, as both sides equal 4.

**Q.21 · Answer (C) 377**
Each term is double the one before plus –1, 3, 1, 5, 3 and 7 in turn (the added number goes up 4 and down 2 alternately): 5 × 2 – 1 = 9, 9 × 2 + 3 = 21, 21 × 2 + 1 = 43, 43 × 2 + 5 = 91, 91 × 2 + 3 = 185, so 185 × 2 + 7 = 377.

**Q.23 · Answer (D) BKZM**
First letters move forward 4 (T, X, B, F, J), second letters forward 9 (S, B, K, T, C), third letters back 12 (X, L, Z, N, B) and fourth letters forward 19 (A, T, M, F, Y): BKZM.

**Q.24 · Answer (A) 1 : 2**
The second number is half of one more than the square of the first: $(3^2 + 1)/2 = 5$, $(7^2 + 1)/2 = 25$ and $(5^2 + 1)/2 = 13$. $(1^2 + 1)/2 = 1$, not 2, so 1 : 2 is the odd pair.

**Q.25 · Answer (D) LXGHBO**
Each letter becomes its opposite in the alphabet (A ↔ Z, B ↔ Y and so on) and each pair of letters is then swapped: LOCATE → OLXZGV → LOZXVG. So COSTLY → XLHGOB → LXGHBO.

### Quantitative Aptitude

**Q.1 · Answer (A) 29**
The five numbers add to 160, the first three to 84 and the last three to 102. 84 + 102 – 160 = 26 is the middle number, counted twice, so the first two add to 84 – 26 = 58: average 29.

**Q.3 · Answer (A) 5**
11.5 – [5 + 0.5 × (9 – 6)] = 11.5 – [5 + 1.5] = 11.5 – 6.5 = 5.

**Q.4 · Answer (B) ₹20,000**
Compound interest for 2 years at 10% is $P(1.1^2 – 1) = 0.21P$ = ₹4,200, so P = ₹20,000.

**Q.5 · Answer (C) 163750**
75 = 3 × 25, so a multiple of 75 must end in 00, 25, 50 or 75 and have a digit sum divisible by 3. 163750 ends in 50, but its digit sum is 22, so it is not divisible by 3 or by 75.

**Q.10 · Answer (D) 30**
The areas of similar triangles are in the ratio of the squares of their sides, so the sides are in the ratio √361 : √225 = 19 : 15. The longest side of ΔABC is 38 × 15/19 = 30 cm.

**Q.11 · Answer (B) ₹2,000**
For 2 years, CI – SI = $P(r/100)^2 = P \times 0.04$ = ₹80, so P = ₹2,000.

**Q.12 · Answer (B) decrease by 0.64%**
1.08 × 0.92 = 0.9936 of the original price: a decrease of 0.64% ($8^2 \div 100$).

**Q.13 · Answer (C) ₹108**
18% of ₹600 = ₹108.

**Q.14 · Answer (C) –8%**
1.15 × 0.80 = 0.92 of the original price: a net change of –8%.

**Q.15 · Answer (D) 25**
The expression is $a^2 – 2ab + b^2 = (b – a)^2$ with a = 0.14 and b = 5.14: $(5.14 – 0.14)^2 = 5^2 = 25$.

**Q.16 · Answer (C) 18**
3600 m = 3.6 km and 12 minutes = 1/5 hour, so the speed is 3.6 × 5 = 18 km/h.

**Q.18 · Answer (A) 1:3**
As fractions: 3/4 = 0.75, 1/2 = 0.5, 2/5 = 0.4 and 1/3 ≈ 0.33, so 1 : 3 is the smallest.

**Q.21 · Answer (A) 800gm**
Giving x g for the price of 1,000 g yields a 25% profit when 1000/x = 1.25, so x = 800 g.

**Q.24 · Answer (A) 18**
With n workers: 8,850n = 9 × 10,000 + (n − 9) × 7,780, so 1,070n = 19,980 and n = 18.67; the integral part is 18.

## General Awareness

**Q.1 · Answer (B) Wladimir Koppen**
Wladimir Köppen's classification, set out around 1900 and revised later, groups climates by temperature, the amount of rainfall and the season in which it falls.

**Q.2 · Answer (A) tabla**
Ustad Allah Rakha, father of Zakir Hussain, was a celebrated tabla player who often accompanied Ravi Shankar.

**Q.3 · Answer (D) Lewis Hamilton**
Lewis Hamilton's win at the 2021 Russian Grand Prix in Sochi was his 100th in Formula One, the first time any driver had reached 100.

**Q.4 · Answer (A) Hindustani music vocalist**
Pandit Bhimsen Joshi was a Hindustani classical vocalist of the Kirana gharana.

**Q.5 · Answer (A) Bacillus cereus**
Bacillus cereus produces toxins and spoils dairy products, curdling milk and giving it a bitter taste. Streptococcus thermophilus, Bifidobacterium and Lactobacillus plantarum are beneficial bacteria used in yoghurt, cheese and probiotics.

**Q.6 · Answer (B) Gandak River**
The Gandak, formed by the Kaligandak and the Trishulganga, rises in Nepal and joins the Ganga at Sonpur, near Patna.

**Q.7 · Answer (A) Bharatanatyam**
Guru M. K. Saroja, a Bharatanatyam dancer and teacher from Chennai, received the Padma Shri in 2011.

**Q.8 · Answer (C) Nirad C. Chaudhuri**
'The Autobiography of an Unknown Indian' (1951) is Nirad C. Chaudhuri's account of his early life.

**Q.9 · Answer (A) Padma Shri**
Vedantam Satyanarayana Sarma, a Kuchipudi dancer famous for female roles such as Satyabhama, received the Padma Shri in 1970.

**Q.10 · Answer (C) Alcoholic fermentation**
In alcoholic fermentation, yeast and some bacteria break down sugars such as glucose into ethyl alcohol and carbon dioxide without oxygen.

**Q.12 · Answer (A) Madhya Pradesh**
The Kalidas Samman is presented by the Government of Madhya Pradesh.

**Q.13 · Answer (B) Observation of bacteria and protozoa**
Using microscopes he made himself, Antonie van Leeuwenhoek was the first to observe bacteria and protozoa, which he called 'animalcules'.

**Q.15 · Answer (B) AR Rahman**
A. R. Rahman, called 'the Mozart of Madras', was named in Time's 2009 list of the world's 100 most influential people.

**Q.16 · Answer (D) Ruskin Bond**
'The Room on the Roof', Ruskin Bond's first novel, follows Rusty, an orphaned boy who leaves his strict guardian's home in Dehra.

**Q.17 · Answer (C) Mumbai**
Mumbai hosted the 141st IOC Session in October 2023, the first in India since New Delhi's in 1983.

**Q.18 · Answer (C) Nandini Sengupta**
'The King Within' is a historical novel by Nandini Sengupta.

**Q.19 · Answer (C) Rahul Dravid**
Rahul Dravid was appointed head coach of the Indian men's cricket team in November 2021, succeeding Ravi Shastri after the T20 World Cup.

**Q.20 · Answer (B) Groups**
The vertical columns of the periodic table are groups; the horizontal rows are periods.

**Q.21 · Answer (C) Kuchipudi**
Vedantam Satyanarayana Sarma was a Kuchipudi dancer, famous for female roles such as Satyabhama.

**Q.22 · Answer (D) Jamshedpur**
The JRD Tata Sports Complex is in Jamshedpur, Jharkhand.

**Q.23 · Answer (D) 62**
Under Article 217 a High Court judge holds office until the age of 62; Supreme Court judges retire at 65.

**Q.24 · Answer (A) 1976**
Regional Rural Banks were first set up in 1975 under an ordinance, which the Regional Rural Banks Act replaced in 1976.

**Q.25 · Answer (C) Kathak**
Purushottam Dadheech, a Kathak guru from Madhya Pradesh, received the Padma Shri in 2020.

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